TOMISLAV MESARIĆ

BUTCHER / MEAT COUNTER ASSISTANT

Ulica Lipa 12, 10000 Zagreb, Croatia | +385 1 555 0142 | tomislav.mesaric@example.com

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Butcher with experience in high-street, market, and family-shop butchery since 2015, including carcass breakdown, boning, trimming, portioning and fresh sausage production. Experienced in customer service, FIFO stock rotation, temperature and hygiene checks, and training apprentices. Holds a vocational butcher certificate and a basic HACCP food hygiene certificate.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb | 2019–present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides weekly; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Produce approximately 40 kg of fresh sausage weekly in the busy season, including ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb in response to customer feedback; the ćevapi won second place at the 2023 Zagreb County craft meat fair.
- Rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, placing the oldest products at the front.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve approximately 120 customers on a Saturday and advise on meat cuts and cooking times.
- Train two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting events, including ordering, butchering, seasoning and delivery. Largest order: four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in 2024.
- Conducted a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs at 21 and 28 days, recording temperature and weight loss. Dry-aged rib is now sold by pre-order, at approximately 15 kg per month.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb | 2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised the slicer, mincer and counter at closing.
- Created a one-page closing and cleaning checklist following a hygiene inspection remark; the checklist remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024
Preparing for the Master Butcher Exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027

KEY SKILLS

Carcass breakdown: beef, pork and lamb · Boning, trimming and portioning · Fresh sausage making · FIFO stock rotation · HACCP food hygiene · Cold-chain temperature checks · Customer advice on cuts and cooking · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Cleaning and sanitising equipment · Cash handling · Apprentice training

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good; customer service) · German (basic)